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Dr. Vishwanath Karad

**MIT WORLD PEACE
UNIVERSITY** | PUNE

TECHNOLOGY, RESEARCH, SOCIAL INNOVATION & PARTNERSHIPS

MONSOONS AND MILESTONES

Monthly Newsletter |

JULY 2024 | Volume 22

Pulse 
THE HEARTBEAT OF MIT-WPU



SHRI RAHUL V. KARAD
EXECUTIVE PRESIDENT, MIT-WPU

Dear Readers ,

As the monsoon heralds the onset of refreshing rains across Bharat, it marks a climatic shift and a season bustling with academic and professional milestones. While the rains rejuvenate the landscapes, bringing much-needed relief and support to our agricultural backbone, the essence of this season in our academic and professional calendars is increasingly defined by significant events and new beginnings.

As the monsoon begins, college campuses nationwide buzz with the energy of students returning for a new academic year. The season is not just about the lush greenery or the cool showers but also about welcoming fresh minds eager to embark on their educational journeys.

MIT World Peace University embarks on its own set of milestones this monsoon!

In an extraordinary gathering this month, over 130 eminent and distinguished scientists, researchers, academicians, and industry leaders convened at the first-ever National Scientists Round Table Conference (NSRTC). This prestigious event, featuring distinguished Padma awardees, Bhatnagar prize winners, and INSA medalists, fostered groundbreaking discussions and collaborations that could shape the future of scientific inquiry and innovation for Viksit Bharat 2047.

Simultaneously, we are preparing to celebrate the accomplishments of over 160 UPSC exam qualifiers at our upcoming felicitation ceremony. This event will honour the future IAS and IPS officers set to embark on careers that will influence governance and policy-making in our nation. Their success is a testament to the rigorous preparation and dedication that define the aspirational spirit of our students.

While the monsoon traditionally inspires poets and painters, its impact on our academic and professional landscapes is equally poetic. The seasonal transformation it brings is mirrored in the lives of students and professionals taking monumental steps in their careers during this period. As we move forward, these events during the monsoon symbolise not just the cyclic renewal of nature but also the continual advancement of our society and the nurturing of its future leaders.

In this context, the monsoon in Bharat transcends its role as a mere season; it becomes a backdrop to the vibrant tapestry of events that enrich our educational and professional spheres, reflecting a dynamic blend of tradition and progress.

HAPPENINGS

Celebrating Professional Competencies

The Department of Education feels proud to share that the students have qualified the CTET Examination which is mandatory to become a teacher. Following students cleared their CTET exam during their B.Ed. program.

- | | |
|--------------------------|------------------------|
| 1.Suman Gautam | 5.Charushila Junghare. |
| 2. Maitri Kapadia | 6.Sheetal Deshpande |
| 3.Debasmita Mukhopadhyay | 7.Srirupa Dutta Deb |
| 4.Sanghamitra Roy | 8.Maya Gaikwad |

Farewell for Second Year students

We bid a heartfelt "Adieu" to the Second Year B.Ed. and M.Ed. students of the Department of Education. Dr. Pallavi Soman, Principal, Mahaveer English School was the Chief Guest and Ms. Damini Joshi, Principal, and alumni of Department of Education was the Guest of Honour for the program. Dr. Pallavi Soman enlightened the future teachers about the paradigm shift in education due to Artificial Intelligence and the evolving role of teachers in today's era. She emphasised the urge to blend the technology with traditional pedagogies to sustain in the teaching field and practise the innovative methods to cater the diverse needs of the students. Her words motivated the future teachers to become facilitators with a student centric approach. Ms. Damini Joshi, Alumni of MIT-WPU and Principal, Sanskriti School, expressed her gratitude for graduating from this institution and explained how it helped her to develop professional competencies through B.Ed. program. She acknowledged teachers as the creators and nurturers of future generations. Dr. Archana Chaudhari, the Program Director of the Department of Education, reflected on the timeless nobility of the teaching profession. She explained the changing expectations from society for the teachers that raised the standards of the teaching profession. Ms. Sampada Joshi, S.Y. M.Ed. got the "Best Researcher Award" and Ms. Srirupa Dutta, S.Y. B. Ed got the "Best Student of the Year Award". The farewell ceremony was an emotional reminder of the transformative journey these students had embarked upon during their time at the Department of Education. It marked a milestone in their lives as they prepared to step into the world as future educators.



In the *SPOTLIGHT*

Co-Creation Research Institute Initiative

The Co-Creation Research Institute of MIT World Peace University (MIT-WPU) was conceptualised under the guidance of Shri. Rahul Karad, Executive President, MIT-WPU and Dr. Joske Bunders, VU University, Amsterdam. In National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 it is stated that higher educational institutions should transform themselves and adapt their learning pedagogies from “rote learning and learning-for-exams” to more focus on “personal accomplishment and enlightenment, constructive public engagement, and productive contribution to the society”. MIT-WPU is already working very hard to take steps in this transformation process where more than ten thousand students participated in Co-Creation for Problem Solving Activity since 2022. In the next phase Co-Creation Research Institute will be tying up with various Educational Institutions in rural areas and help them in solving the societal problems from their area.

To start with, the team along with Dr. Joske Bunders, Director Co-Creation Research Institute, Dr. Sheila Ramaswamy, Consultant Co-Creation Research Institute visited the Sahakar Maharshi Bhausaheb Santuji Thorat college of Arts, Commerce and Science College, Sangamner and discussed various problems from the rural area. The core team members Dr. Gopinath T. and Asst. Prof. Priya Kale conducted the training for 25 faculties and explained the Co-creation methodology to solve the problems. Mr. Sudhir Tambe, a former member of the Maharashtra Legislative Council from the Nashik Graduate constituency in Maharashtra, India and Dr. Dinanath Patil, Principal, welcomed the team members and assured the participation of the staff and students of their college regarding initiating the Co-Creation Program for problem solving in society.



Tree Plantation Activity Report

On July 10, 2024, a successful tree plantation activity was conducted for second-year BBA students, aimed at promoting environmental awareness and contributing to the local ecosystem. The event, held in NDA Bhamburda Forest, Pune, saw over 100 students enthusiastically participate, planting more than 500 trees. This significantly exceeded the initial target of 100 trees, underscoring the commitment of the participants.

The primary objectives were to educate students on the environmental benefits of trees, foster teamwork, and contribute to the community. Students worked in groups of seven, each tasked with planting 10 to 12 trees. The process included digging holes, planting saplings, watering them, and ensuring proper cleanup, all under the supervision of faculty members and environmental experts from the Care Foundation.

The activity not only provided hands-on experience in tree planting but also enhanced students' understanding of environmental stewardship. The event was well-organised, with light refreshments provided to keep energy levels high and ensure hydration.

Acknowledgements are extended to Dr. Deependra Sharma, Dr. Swati Bankar, Dr. Pradip Padhye, Dr. Girish Mude, and all participating faculty members for their crucial support. This initiative marked a significant step towards environmental sustainability and highlighted the importance of community involvement in conservation efforts.



Streamlining Academic Operations: A Successful Implementation of PwC Software

We are delighted to announce the successful implementation of the PwC Academic Software System, a groundbreaking initiative designed to enhance our academic and administrative processes. This milestone achievement was celebrated with an Academic Orientation Session held on July 4, 2024, at Vivekanand Hall.

The orientation session was meticulously planned to provide a comprehensive introduction to the new software. Attendees were treated to a detailed overview of the system's advanced features and benefits, highlighting its potential to streamline various academic and administrative tasks. The event aimed to equip participants with the knowledge and skills necessary for a seamless transition to the new system.

The session kicked off with an insightful presentation that outlined the key functionalities of the PwC Academic Software System. The speakers emphasized how the system will improve academic administration in efficiency, accuracy, and overall user experience. The presentation was followed by live demonstrations of the software, showcasing essential tasks such as course management, student information tracking, and administrative workflows.

One of the highlights of the orientation was the interactive Q&A session. This segment allowed attendees to voice their specific queries and concerns, which were addressed by the expert panel. The panel included IT specialists and academic administrators who have been closely involved in the implementation process. Their expertise ensured that all questions were comprehensively answered, leaving participants with a thorough understanding of the software's capabilities and practical applications.

The feedback from the attendees was encouraging and positive. Many appreciated the step-by-step guide provided during the session, which facilitated easier navigation and utilization of the software. The hands-on demonstrations were particularly well-received, as they offered a practical glimpse into the day-to-day use of the system.

For those who were unable to attend the orientation session, a recording of the event, along with additional resources, will be made available. These resources will include user manuals, video tutorials, and FAQs to assist users in getting acquainted with the new system. Furthermore, the IT department remains on hand to provide ongoing support and address any technical issues that may arise during the transition period.

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to everyone who participated in the orientation session and contributed to its success. The implementation of the PwC Academic Software System marks a significant step forward in enhancing our academic operations. The new software has been successfully implemented in all the systems and the first response has been overwhelmingly positive. It has streamlined the operations at the academics and front desks, increasing efficiency and processing capacity to better deal with the task system. Stay tuned for further updates on how this innovative system will continue to benefit our institution.





MIT-WPU School of Business Ranks 9th Nationally

We are proud to announce that the School of Business at MIT World Peace University (MIT-WPU) has been ranked 9th in India in the prestigious TIMES BBA Education Ranking Survey 2024. This recognition is a testament to our unwavering commitment to excellence in business education.

The ranking is based on the rigorous i3RC-BRM model developed by i3RC insights, which evaluates institutions through a comprehensive 360-degree perspective. This proprietary methodology assesses BBA programs across three critical dimensions: resources, effort, and outcomes. The resources dimension evaluates the quality and availability of facilities, faculty, and learning materials.

Our inclusion in the top 10 of India reflects the outstanding quality of our academic programs, the dedication of our faculty, and the exceptional achievements of our students. We remain committed to nurturing future leaders and innovators who will make a significant impact in the global business landscape.

National Scientists Round Table Conference (NSRTC 2024)

MIT World Peace University (MIT-WPU) announces the successful conclusion of the 1st National Scientists Round Table Conference (NSRTC 2024), a landmark event held from July 19 to July 21, 2024. The conference, themed "Science and Technology for Viksit Bharat 2047," brought together esteemed dignitaries, scholars, and visionaries to discuss pivotal themes shaping India's scientific future.

The three-day conference brought together top academicians, scientists, researchers, and scholars. The focus was on exchanging insights and research across Physical Sciences, Life Sciences, and Engineering & Technology. NSRTC 2024 highlighted key topics such as Artificial Intelligence, Quantum Technology, Science & Spirituality, Sustainability, Healthcare and World Peace. The event aimed to spark innovative ideas, especially among young researchers, and promote interdisciplinary and global collaborations for new discoveries and sustainable development.

We envision a future powered by education, innovation, and culture, one that is sustainable, inclusive, and fosters progressive societal transformation ("Powering The Future"). To achieve this, we cultivate a culture of excellence with three pillars: fostering exemplary leadership, prioritising empathy and improving the present for all, and emphasising interdisciplinary collaboration in our educational approach. Ultimately, we believe that true global peace and harmony can be reached through the concordant integration of Science and Spirituality.



MIT-WPU PRODIGIES

Employee of the Month



Mr. Ashish Kamble
Admissions

Ashish's dedication and work ethic are truly commendable. In the past month alone, he has efficiently processed over 800 plus self-registrations, ensuring a seamless experience for our applicants. His attention to detail and commitment to accuracy have significantly contributed to the successful conversion of these applicants into provisional admissions. What truly sets Ashish apart is his unwavering commitment to helping students and parents. He goes above and beyond the call of duty, providing assistance beyond the limits of his role. His self-motivation, kindness, and soft-spoken demeanor create a positive and welcoming environment for everyone he interacts with.



Mr. Alok Audhkar
DIV 1- Mechanical Engineering
(Lab assistant)- Non teaching

Alok successfully repaired machines, including the Spring Back Machine and a 3D printer, resulting in a cost savings of ₹65,000. He also completed the NABL Accreditation Course and developed and maintained a new PG Research Lab. Additionally, Alok also attended a one-week training course at SVNIT Surat and learned how to use 3D printing software. He also assisted newly joined staff to support their further improvement.

Employee of the Month



Mr. Rahul Karle
Senior Karad Sirs Office

Mr. Karle's works in Sr.Karad Sir's office since 1995, and his ethic is exemplary; he consistently arrives before Senior Karad Sir and departs only after ensuring all tasks are completed, often working 12-hour days. His relentless pursuit of excellence, both within and beyond the campus, showcases his remarkable and extraordinary contributions.

Mr. Karle's commitment to his duties, always being on his toes to accomplish tasks efficiently and effectively, makes him a valuable asset to our team. His dedication and consistent efforts set a high standard for all.



Mr. Dattatrya Satpute
Security & Vigilance
Department

Dattatrya Satpute's notable contributions include renewing Arms Licences for Senior Management, coordinating police and military bands for events, and providing fire tenders for annual gatherings. He resolved a sexual harassment case with the Dhamini Squad's help, drafted and implemented a Parking

Management Policy, and introduced a Colour Coded Stickers policy for staff. He formulated SOPs for the Security and Vigilance department, resolved court cases related to disputes, encroachments, and theft, coordinated security measures with local authorities on DP Road, and arranged helicopter bookings and permissions for VVIP movements and events.

PAINTING *with* **WORDS**

Some myths and facts about **RAIN**

Surprising facts about Rain

- We cannot find a place on earth which has not seen rain
- At some places rain drops never reach to the ground as there are some jungles with huge trees where rain falls only on the trees
- Raindrops have certain shapes like spherical or a hamburger bun
- It takes 2 to 7 minutes for a raindrop to reach the ground based on their size and weight
- As per the scientist it is raining since 2.7 billion years ago
- Mawsynram, a village in Meghalaya is known as rainiest place on the earth
- Snowdonia in Wales is known for having very less rain on earth
- The Fish rain is experienced by Yoro in Honduras once a year where the small silver fishes fall along with the rain on the ground
- As per the history, Hippalus discovered Monsoon wind in AD 45-47
- Monsoon word is derived from the Arabic word "Mausim" which means season of winds
- According to many religious beliefs, rain is a blessing or a gift from god and flood results as a curse for sin

Rituals for calling the rain around the world

- Australian Aboriginal people practice the Frog dance ritual to awaken the frogs so that they can bring rain
- The Tibetan monks start chanting the prayers for the god and goddesses of the sky and water to call rain
- In Bangladesh people arrange Bhekuli Biya (marriage of frogs) during summer to invoke rain
- The Haitian people perform exotic rain dance named "The Vodou Rain Dance" to bring rain

Proverbs related to rain

- August rain
- Right as rain
- Dew on the grass
- Saving for the rainy day
- Some people feel rain
- Let the rain kiss you

Festivals to celebrate rain

- Minjar : Himachal Pradesh, India
- Harela : Uttarakhand, India
- Nariya Pornima / Raksha Bandhan : India
- Hemis Festival : Ladakh, India
- Hareli : Chhattisgarh, India
- Onam : Kerala, India
- Behdienkhlam : Meghalaya, India
- Adiperukku : Tamilnadu, India
- Festa Junina : Brazil
- Bunga Dyah Jatra : Nepal
- Longtaitou Festival, China
- The rocket festival : Thailand
- Hae Nang Maew - The cat procession festival : Thailand
- Makahiki : Hawaii
- Ha Giang : Vietnam

Unforgettable disasters caused by rain

- Panshet Dam 1967
- Super Cyclone Odisha 1999
- The Indian Ocean Tsunami 2004
- Mumbai flood 2005
- Uttarakhand flood 2013
- Kerala Flood 2018

Compiled by :
Asst. Prof. Priya Kale
Dept. of Education, MIT-WPU



संधी काली या अशा धुंदल्या दिशा दिशा....
जेथे मिळे धरेला आभाळ वाकलेले.....



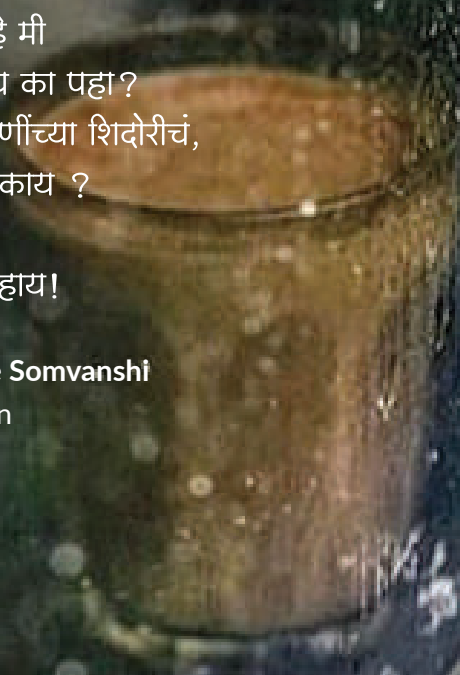
Dr. Nitin S Joshi
IQAC NAAC Office,
Librarian KRC,
Chairman Scrap Committee
MIT World Peace University
(MITWPU)



पावसाचं काय ?

दरवर्षी पाऊस येतच राहणार.
उन्हाने पाण्याची वाफ होणार,
मग ती पाऊस म्हणून बरसणार,
हे असं कायम चालूच राहणार.
पण या आठवणींचं करायचं काय ?
त्या तर येणारच जशी दुधावर येते साय.
साठवणीतल्या आठवणीने आधीच भरलाय कप्पा,
चला यावेळी तरी रित्या करूया म्हटलं,
पण तो मार्ग अजिबात नाही सोप्या
हे बघा, येतच राहणार पाऊस,
आणि पुन्हा येणार आठवणी,
त्याचा तो बरसात राहणार,
आपण मात्र करणार उजळणी.
अधून मधून कधी येत होता तर कधी जात होता पाऊस,
सगळ्या आठवणींना मात्र एकदमच येण्याची होती भारी हौस!
तिकडे कधी मुसळधार, तर कधी हलकीशी सर
इकडे पापण्यांना पेलवत नाही म्हणून अश्रूंची भर.
तरी नशीबच म्हणायचं की पडल्या नाहीत गारा,
नाहीतर कसा आवरला असता हा आठवणींचा पसारा ?
ठरवलं होतं मी आज की थांबायचं घरी,
आल्या जरी सरी किंवा नाही आल्या तरी.
तेवढ्यात आली pulse ची मेल
पावसावर काहीतरी लिहा,
तसं लिहिलं तर आहे मी
काही शीर्षक सुचतंय का पहा ?
बरं सांगा तरी आठवणींच्या शिंदोरीचं,
आपण करणार तरी काय ?
बाकी हा पाऊस तर
येत जातच राहणार हाय!

Asst. Prof. Prachee Somvanshi
School of Education



Blood donation behaviour and strategies to bridge gap for new India

- Do you know an estimated 14.6 million blood units are needed annually, yet a crucial gap of 1 million units persists (MoHFW, PIB report 2023). This shortage can have devastating consequences, impacting emergency procedures, surgeries, and treatment for blood disorders like Thalassemia. While strides have been made, bridging this gap is critical.
- Recent research sheds light on donor motivations and the factors influencing blood donation in India and reveals a mix of altruistic and self-centred motives. Many donate blood out of a sense of social responsibility and a desire to help others in need. While altruism is a primary motivator suggesting additional factors that may influence donation behaviour such as incentives like free medical checkups, and family or friends pressure can influence behaviour.
- Moreover, in rural areas, several issues contribute to ongoing challenges. Taboos and societal norms often impede progress, while poor healthcare and malnutrition are exacerbated by inadequate medical infrastructure at the block and tehsil levels. Additionally, there is a significant lack of knowledge among 'anganwadi' workers, 'sakhis', and healthcare workers, which hampers effective intervention. Further, casteism remains a prevalent practice in rural areas, further complicating efforts to improve conditions in these communities.
- Demographics also play a role. Another 2016 study by Saha, S., and Chandra at Current Science highlights the influence of age and education on blood donation. Younger adults tend to be less likely to donate compared to older generations. Similarly, individuals with higher education levels exhibit a greater willingness to donate.



- Apart from the behaviour perspective, challenges within the blood banking system itself are another hurdle. Inadequate infrastructure, limited accessibility of blood banks, and concerns about blood quality and service quality can deter potential donors. According to the 2016 study most of the first-time blood donors avoid their second donation not just because of medical reasons but for pandemonium conditions such as long, arduous screening time and incompetent staff behaviour
- India's blood donation landscape requires a multi-pronged approach. By addressing donor motivations, demographic considerations, and challenges within the blood banking system, India can move towards a more sustainable and reliable blood supply. This, in turn, will save countless lives and ensure that the life stream continues to flow uninterrupted.

Dr. Shantanu Saha

Assistant Professor- Marketing
Ramcharan School of Leadership



Your Living



Dear Esteemed Readers,

As we conclude the latest edition of Pulse, themed "Monsoons and Milestones," I want to take a moment to extend my deepest gratitude and appreciation to each of you. This edition has been a celebration of two of the most significant aspects of our lives—nature's bounty and our collective achievements.

To every farmer who tirelessly works the land, nurturing crops with the lifeblood of the monsoon rains, to every individual who marks personal and professional milestones with hard work and dedication, your efforts symbolise resilience and growth.

In this edition, we have highlighted stories of extraordinary accomplishments, from communities thriving in harmony with nature to individuals reaching new heights in their personal and professional journeys.

As we sign off this edition, I want to express my heartfelt thanks to our contributors, whose insights and perspectives have enriched our understanding, and to you, our readers, for your unwavering support and engagement. Your enthusiasm and feedback are what drive us to bring forth meaningful and thought-provoking content.

Let us carry forward the spirit of this theme in our daily lives, remembering that both monsoons and milestones represent cycles of renewal and progress. Together, let us continue to embrace the challenges and celebrate the achievements that make our journey worthwhile.

Thank you for being a part of this journey. Until next time, stay inspired, stay engaged, and cherish every milestone along the way.

You are living Pulse

Narrative by - Priyanshu Pandey

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Want to contribute to Pulse?

Send us your write-ups and departmental stories at:
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